

UNIT 4

HERBIVORES, CARNIVORES, AND OMNIVORES

Learning objectives:

- Define herbivores, carnivores, and omnivores based on their diet.
- Identify animals that belong to each category.
- Describe the special features (teeth, claws, beaks) that help animals eat their food.
- Compare the differences between herbivores, carnivores, and omnivores.
- Explain the role of each type of animal in the food chain.
- Classify animals correctly based on their diet through activities and exercises.

Animals need food to survive, and they eat different kinds of food. Based on their diet, animals are classified into three main groups: **herbivores, carnivores, and omnivores**. Each type of animal has special body features to help them eat their specific food.

Types of Animals Based on Their Diet

1. Herbivores

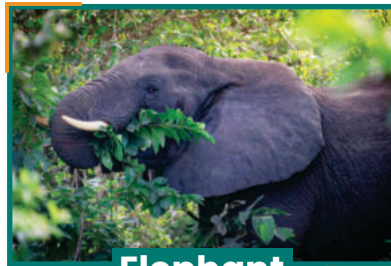
Herbivores are animals that **only eat plants**. They eat leaves, grass, fruits, and stems. Many herbivores have flat teeth to help them chew plants.

Examples of Herbivores:

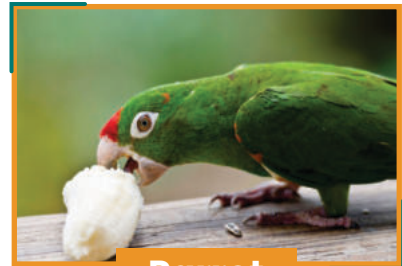
- **Mammals** – Elephants, cows, deer, rabbits.
- **Insects** – Grasshoppers, caterpillars.
- **Birds** – Parrots, pigeons.



Cow



Elephant



Parrot

2. Carnivores

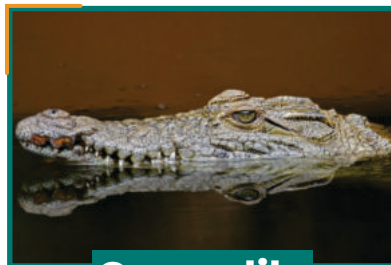
Carnivores are animals that **only eat meat**. They hunt other animals or scavenge for food. Carnivores have sharp teeth and claws to catch and eat their prey.

Examples of Carnivores:

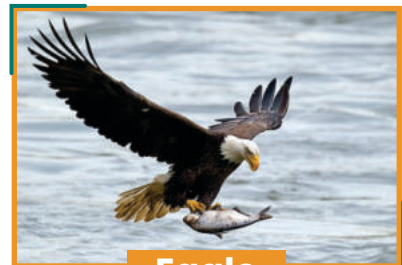
- **Mammals** – Tigers, lions, wolves.
- **Reptiles** – Crocodiles, snakes.
- **Birds** – Eagles, hawks.



Tiger



Crocodile



Eagle

3. Omnivores

Omnivores eat **both plants and animals**. They can eat fruits, vegetables, insects, and meat. Omnivores have both sharp and flat teeth to chew different kinds of food.

Examples of Omnivores:

- **Mammals** – Humans, bears, raccoons.
- **Birds** – Crows, chickens.
- **Reptiles** – Turtles.





Bear



Chicken



Human

Why is This Classification Important?

Understanding how animals are classified based on their diet helps us learn more about the natural world. It allows us to see how animals interact with their environment and how they depend on different food sources for survival.



Critical Thinking

If all the herbivores disappeared, how do you think it would affect the other animals? Why is it important to have different kinds of animals that eat different things?



Test Your Understanding

Q1: What are herbivores?

Ans: _____

Q2: What are carnivores?

Ans: _____

Q3: Why do herbivore chew their food?

Ans: _____



Q4: Why do some animals eat both plants and meat?

Ans: _____





Fill in the blanks.

1. Herbivores eat _____ and have _____ teeth.
2. Lions and tigers are _____ because they eat meat.
3. Chickens and bears are _____ because they eat
both plants and meat.
4. Crocodiles and snakes are examples of _____ .
5. A cow is _____ because it eats plants.
6. An eagle is _____ because it hunts other animals
for food.



Tick (✓) for True and cross (x) for False statements.

1. All animals eat the same type of food. ()

2. Herbivores eat plants, and carnivores eat meat. ()

3. A tiger is herbivore. ()

4. An omnivore eats both plants and animals. ()

5. Cows have sharp teeth to chew meat. ()

6. Snakes are carnivores. ()



Choose the correct answer:

1. Why do herbivores have flat teeth?

- a) To eat meat
- b) To help chew plants
- c) To catch prey

2. How do carnivores get their food?

- a) By growing it
- b) By hunting
- c) By eating soil

3. What type of diet do omnivores have?

- a) Only plants
- b) Only meat
- c) Both plants and meat

4. Why do eagles have sharp beaks?

- a) To help them eat plants
- b) To help them catch and eat prey
- c) To dig in the soil

5. What happens if an herbivore eats meat?

- a) It will digest it easily
- b) It may get sick
- c) It will grow faster



6. Which of these animals is an omnivore?

- a) Cow
- b) Lion
- c) Bear



Match each animal to correct group.

Bear



HERBIVORE

Rhinoceros



Pelican



CARNIVORE

Camel



Monkey



Fox



Goat



OMNIVORE

Penguin



Identify each animal as a herbivore or carnivore.









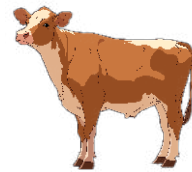


Label each organism as herbivore, carnivore or omnivore.

Owl



Cow



Elephant



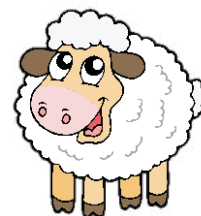
Hen



Hedgehog



Sheep





Activity: Food Chain Role-Play



ACTIVITY

Objective:

Students will understand how herbivores, carnivores, and omnivores interact in a food chain.

Materials Needed:

- Animal masks or pictures (cow, lion, human, eagle, rabbit, etc.).
- Labels for different food sources (grass, fruits, meat, etc.).

Instructions:

1. Assign students different roles: **herbivores, carnivores, omnivores, and plants.**
2. Give herbivores plant labels (e.g., "I eat grass").
3. Carnivores will be assigned herbivores to "eat" (e.g., "I hunt deer").
4. Omnivores will have mixed food options (e.g., "I eat both fruits and meat").
5. Students will act out how they get their food and what happens in a food chain.

